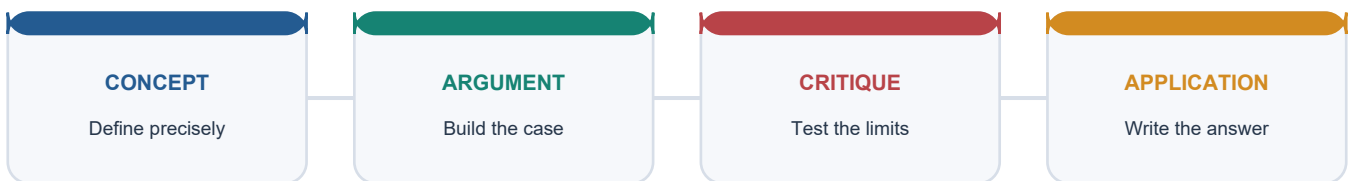


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Common Good and Community - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Common Good and Community - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 21 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Answer:?**

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: the source records this exact proposition - the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Misplaced: abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify the justified welfare of the whole political community by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.
- B. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- C. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- D. moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B This is the recorded association: the source records this exact proposition - an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- **C:** C Misplaced: a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify an empirically discoverable convergence among affected by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is an empirically discoverable convergence among affected.

MCQ 3

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.
- B. Gandhian ideal of uplift or awakening of all, especially the last and neglected person, through non-violent moral order.
- C. a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- D. an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Misplaced: gandhian ideal of uplift or awakening of all, especially the last and neglected person, through non-violent is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: an employer-labour settlement is not common good when consumers or displaced groups bear hidden costs is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify a public authority's justificatory decision about policy by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is a public authority's justificatory decision about policy.

MCQ 4

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion.
- B. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- C. shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: shared practices and memberships partly constitute persons and their goods is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Examiner trap: Do not identify continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than.

MCQ 5

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- B. antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good.
- C. what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
- D. continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - a right constitution serves the good life of the whole community.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: antagonistic class society cannot realise a genuinely common good is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Not this pair: continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify a right constitution serves the good life of the whole by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is a right constitution serves the good life of the whole.

MCQ 6

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- B. a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- C. abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
- D. market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.
- **C:** C Not this pair: abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify a public-regarding will directed to common good rather by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is a public-regarding will directed to common good rather.

MCQ 7

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.
- B. the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Not this pair: the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source-exact: the source records this exact proposition - political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a.

MCQ 8

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict.
- B. market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction.
- C. political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.
- D. civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: market valuation can stunt human capacities and therefore needs welfare-oriented correction is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: the source records this exact proposition - civil rules adjust individual interests while rights protect persons from mutual oppression.

Examiner trap: Do not identify civil rules adjust individual interests while rights by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is civil rules adjust individual interests while rights.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B:** B Misplaced: Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Common interest.

MCQ 11

Which pair keeps the proposition with the name or concept the source attaches it to?

- A. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **D:** D Mismatched: Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Common good.

MCQ 12

Which pairing is exact, rather than borrowed from an adjacent part of the same topic?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Mismatched: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **D:** D Not this pair: Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Consensus.

MCQ 13

One pairing below is faithful to the source. Which one?

- A. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **B:** B Mismatched: Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).

- **D: D Wrong attachment:** Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Public interest.

MCQ 14

Which label-proposition pair would not be corrected by the source text?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)
- C. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A Mismatched:** Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B: B Source disagrees:** Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).
- **C: C Wrong attachment:** Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **D: D Not this pair:** Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions n.

MCQ 15

Which of the following associations is reproduced exactly as recorded?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A: A Not this pair:** Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B: B Wrong attachment:** Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).

- **C:** C Source disagrees: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **D:** D Misplaced: Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences.

MCQ 16

Which pair matches its proposition without drifting to a related concept?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Common interest - A judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475)
- C. Public interest - The process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as absolute personal property but as a trust held for service of humanity. (PDF pp.487-488)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Common interest is recorded with an empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Public interest is recorded with a judgment-oriented political-administrative notion used to justify a public decision sensitive to people's needs and aspirations. (PDF p.475).
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Consensus is recorded with the process through which groups resolve differences and arrive at an arrangement suited to shared needs under existing constraints. (PDF pp.477-479).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions not as; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 3: Consensus - Gandhi's doctrine that the rich should treat possessions n.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: what strengthens a state apparatus may still injure the common good.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: trusteeship and renunciation depend heavily on sustained moral conversion.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.

- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 2 only.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: aggregate happiness cannot justify treating a minority's suffering as expendable.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: moral richness does not automatically supply accountable institutions for resolving conflict.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: market prices may undervalue socially necessary but weakly remunerated capacities.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: continuing accommodation of disagreement rather than complete unanimity.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 1 only.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: the justified welfare of the whole political community rather than one faction's gain.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: 2 only.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: abolition of private class power can still be followed by new political domination.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: an empirically discoverable convergence among affected persons, narrower than the normative common good.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: a public authority's justificatory decision about policy, which should remain answerable to the wider common good.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Common good is just the sum total of private interests.?**

- A. Gauba explicitly distinguishes it from bargaining outcomes and factional aggregation. (PDF pp.475-477)
- B. Gauba says the common good may be invoked precisely to stop injustice against a minority. (PDF p.475)
- C. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- D. Both Rawlsian criticism and Gandhian sarvodaya reject sacrificing some for aggregate gain. (PDF p.477, p.490)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly distinguishes it from bargaining outcomes and factional aggregation. (PDF pp.475-477).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good means whatever the majority wants.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good equals utilitarian greatest happiness.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Common good is just the sum total of private interests, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Common good means whatever the majority wants.?**

- A. Both Rawlsian criticism and Gandhian sarvodaya reject sacrificing some for aggregate gain. (PDF p.477, p.490)
- B. Gauba says the common good may be invoked precisely to stop injustice against a minority. (PDF p.475)
- C. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- D. Gauba explicitly distinguishes it from bargaining outcomes and factional aggregation. (PDF pp.475-477)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good equals utilitarian greatest happiness.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says the common good may be invoked precisely to stop injustice against a minority. (PDF p.475).
- **C:** C Mismatched: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good is just the sum total of private interests.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Common good means whatever the majority wants, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Common good equals utilitarian greatest happiness.?**

- A. Gauba says the common good may be invoked precisely to stop injustice against a minority. (PDF p.475)
- B. Gauba explicitly distinguishes it from bargaining outcomes and factional aggregation. (PDF pp.475-477)
- C. Both Rawlsian criticism and Gandhian sarvodaya reject sacrificing some for aggregate gain. (PDF p.477, p.490)
- D. Gandhi relies on trusteeship, ahimsa, bread labour and moral regeneration, not coercive confiscation. (PDF pp.487-490)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good means whatever the majority wants.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good is just the sum total of private interests.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Both Rawlsian criticism and Gandhian sarvodaya reject sacrificing some for aggregate gain. (PDF p.477, p.490).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhian common good means violent leveling of rich and poor.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Common good equals utilitarian greatest happiness, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Marxian common good is already available in capitalist society.?**

- A. Gandhi relies on trusteeship, ahimsa, bread labour and moral regeneration, not coercive confiscation. (PDF pp.487-490)
- B. Gauba presents common good as guiding conflict beyond factionalism, not as abolishing disagreement by decree. (PDF pp.477-479)
- C. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- D. Gauba says Marxism sees class society as organized by antagonistic class interests, not genuine common good. (PDF pp.482-486)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhian common good means violent leveling of rich and poor.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Common-good language ends conflict.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says Marxism sees class society as organized by antagonistic class interests, not genuine common good. (PDF pp.482-486).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Marxian common good is already available in, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Gandhian common good means violent leveling of rich and poor.?**

- A. Gandhi relies on trusteeship, ahimsa, bread labour and moral regeneration, not coercive confiscation. (PDF pp.487-490)
- B. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- C. Gauba says Marxism sees class society as organized by antagonistic class interests, not genuine common good. (PDF pp.482-486)
- D. Gauba presents common good as guiding conflict beyond factionalism, not as abolishing disagreement by decree. (PDF pp.477-479)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gandhi relies on trusteeship, ahimsa, bread labour and moral regeneration, not coercive confiscation. (PDF pp.487-490).
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxian common good is already available in capitalist society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Common-good language ends conflict.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Gandhian common good means violent leveling of rich, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Common-good language ends conflict.**?

- A. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- B. Gauba presents common good as guiding conflict beyond factionalism, not as abolishing disagreement by decree. (PDF pp.477-479)
- C. Gandhi relies on trusteeship, ahimsa, bread labour and moral regeneration, not coercive confiscation. (PDF pp.487-490)
- D. Gauba says Marxism sees class society as organized by antagonistic class interests, not genuine common good. (PDF pp.482-486)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents common good as guiding conflict beyond factionalism, not as abolishing disagreement by decree. (PDF pp.477-479).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhian common good means violent leveling of rich and poor.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxian common good is already available in capitalist society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Common-good language ends conflict, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Answer: means a public-regarding will directed to common good rather than the sum of private wills.**?

- A. Gauba says the common good may be invoked precisely to stop injustice against a minority. (PDF p.475)
- B. Gauba explicitly distinguishes it from bargaining outcomes and factional aggregation. (PDF pp.475-477)
- C. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)
- D. Both Rawlsian criticism and Gandhian sarvodaya reject sacrificing some for aggregate gain. (PDF p.477, p.490)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good means whatever the majority wants.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good is just the sum total of private interests.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Common good equals utilitarian greatest happiness.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Common good, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Answer: means political authority earns moral allegiance by enabling a common good of self-development.**?

- A. Gauba says Marxism sees class society as organized by antagonistic class interests, not genuine common good. (PDF pp.482-486)
- B. Gandhi relies on trusteeship, ahimsa, bread labour and moral regeneration, not coercive confiscation. (PDF pp.487-490)
- C. Gauba presents common good as guiding conflict beyond factionalism, not as abolishing disagreement by decree. (PDF pp.477-479)
- D. Common good - An empirical notion concerning the converging interests of persons likely to be affected by a decision. (PDF p.475)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Marxian common good is already available in capitalist society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhian common good means violent leveling of rich and poor.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Common-good language ends conflict.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Common good is recorded with a normative ideal concerning the welfare of the whole community, transcending the immediate claims of particular individuals or groups. (PDF pp.474-477).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Common good, not a different error from the same topic; here the tested item is Common good.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish common good from public interest and common interest. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of common good from public interest and common interest in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Common, Core and Public, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that a labour-management settlement may express both parties' common interest yet fail the common-good test if consumers bear hidden costs;.

Model answer (140 words):

Introduction: The three expressions operate at different levels. Common good is the widest normative standard: the justified welfare of the whole political community beyond factional, state or numerical advantage. Core analysis: Common interest is narrower and empirical - an overlap among affected persons. Public interest is an authoritative policy judgment claiming to answer a collective need. A labour-management settlement may express both parties' common interest yet fail the common-good test if consumers bear hidden costs; a justified quarantine may be

defended in the public interest and also serve common good. Critical evaluation: The distinction prevents state convenience or coalition strength from becoming self-certifying moral authority. Conclusion: The safest verdict is tripartite: common good is the widest normative standard, common interest is a narrower empirical overlap, and public interest is the authoritative policy judgment that must remain answerable to the common good.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Common, Core and Public), converts that evidence into analysis of common good from public interest and common interest, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that a labour-management settlement may express both parties' common interest yet fail the common-good test if consumers bear hidden costs;. At 140 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is community not identical to majority? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of is community not identical to majority in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Consensus and Critical, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that once majority will is treated as self-justifying, common good collapses into domination of minorities and dissenters.

Model answer (135 words):

Introduction: A majority is a numerical relation; community in common-good reasoning is a normative whole. Gauba therefore rejects equating the common good with the preference of the largest electoral or cultural bloc. Core analysis: The common good may require protecting a minority against majority injustice. Consensus also means continuing accommodation, not the elimination of disagreement. When a dominant religious, caste or linguistic group presents its own way of life as the voice of everyone, sectional interest is merely disguised as community. Critical evaluation: Community-language is defensible only when dissenters and weaker groups retain rights, equal citizenship, voice and review. Constitutional morality is a supplementary safeguard against majoritarian absorption. Conclusion: Community is therefore a normative whole, not a head-count winner; once majority will is treated as self-justifying, common good collapses into domination of minorities and dissenters.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Consensus and Critical), converts that evidence into analysis of is community not identical to majority, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that once majority will is treated as self-justifying, common good collapses into domination of minorities and dissenters. At 135 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Compare liberal and communitarian conceptions of common good. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of liberal and communitarian conceptions of common good in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Liberalism, Core and Rights, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that gauba's Macpherson bridge and welfare correction nevertheless show that market demand may undervalue socially necessary capacities.

Model answer (142 words):

Introduction: Liberalism begins from persons with claims and freedoms; communitarianism begins from socially constituted persons whose goods are shaped by membership and shared purposes. Core analysis: For liberals, common good emerges through reconciliation under civil rules. Rights protect plurality and prevent mutual oppression. Gauba's Macpherson bridge and welfare correction nevertheless show that market demand may undervalue socially necessary capacities. Communitarians reply that the liberal self is too thin: MacIntyre stresses practices and virtues, Taylor dialogical recognition, and Walzer sphere-specific social meanings rather than one distributive metric. Further development: The comparison also turns on how each side handles plurality. A defensible common good therefore combines social embeddedness with protected dissent and institutional review. Conclusion: Liberalism protects plurality by reconciling claims under rights, while communitarianism protects solidarity by locating the self within shared purposes; the stronger answer uses each to correct the other's weakness.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Liberalism, Core and Rights), converts that evidence into analysis of liberal and communitarian conceptions of common good, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that gauba's Macpherson bridge and welfare correction nevertheless show that market demand may undervalue socially necessary capacities. At 142 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Gandhian sarvodaya as a theory of common good. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine Gandhian sarvodaya as a theory of common good in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Sarvodaya, Core and Trusteeship, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Sarvodaya is most defensible as a moral critique of greed, violence and exclusion, but it remains politically adequate only when voluntary ethical transformation is joined to rights, equality and safeguards against hierarchy.

Model answer (200 words):

Introduction: Sarvodaya makes common good a moral-civilisational ideal: uplift of all, especially the neglected, through non-violence, labour and restraint rather than aggregate advantage. Core analysis: Trusteeship treats surplus wealth as a social trust, bread labour joins consumption to dignified physical work, and ahimsa requires unity of means and ends. Gandhi thus rejects both capitalist greed and violent levelling; minority suffering cannot be cancelled by a larger total of benefit. Further development: A further Indian qualification comes from the owner's own objection-reply architecture and verified cross-routes to Gandhi-Ambedkar material. If harmony is invoked without naming caste, social humiliation and structural exclusion, sarvodaya risks sounding like moral reconciliation without equal standing. The answer should therefore distinguish Gandhi's ethical insight from any complacent assumption that voluntary virtue alone can dissolve entrenched hierarchy. Critical evaluation: Its strength is ethical depth and anti-exclusion. Its weakness is implementation: trusteeship and renunciation rely heavily on voluntary change, while harmony-language may understate caste and gender hierarchy. Sarvodaya therefore needs enforceable equality, rights and accountable institutions. Conclusion: Sarvodaya is most defensible as a moral critique of greed, violence and exclusion, but it remains politically adequate only when voluntary ethical transformation is joined to rights, equality and safeguards against hierarchy.

Why this earns marks: it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Sarvodaya, Core and Trusteeship), converts that evidence into analysis of examine Gandhian sarvodaya as a theory of common good, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Sarvodaya is most defensible as a moral critique of greed, violence and exclusion, but it remains politically adequate only when voluntary ethical transformation is joined to rights, equality and safeguards against hierarchy. At 200 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Can common-good reasoning be defended in a plural society without sacrificing minority rights? Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of common-good reasoning be defended in a plural society without sacrificing minority rights in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Common-good, Core and Once, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Yes, but only if common good is defined against state good, majority good and utilitarian expendability, and is disciplined by equal citizenship, dissent, review and constitutional morality.

Model answer (213 words):

Introduction: Common-good reasoning can be defended in a plural society, but only in a qualified form. The first step is to reject three false equations already ruled out by the owner: common good is not state good, not majority good and not utilitarian aggregate gain. Core analysis: Once those errors are removed, the concept can do valuable work. It asks whether citizens can justify shared objectives beyond factional bargaining, while still keeping disagreement legitimate. Liberalism contributes the rights-framework: minorities, dissenters and weaker groups cannot be sacrificed simply because a larger bloc claims to represent the whole. Communitarianism contributes the reminder that citizens

are not detached atoms and that common institutions, practices and social trust matter. The supplementary bridges extend this carefully: civic republicanism adds non-domination and active citizenship, commons-thinking adds the need for institutions that prevent both private enclosure and unaccountable state control, and constitutional morality disciplines inherited social consensus when caste, gender or religious hierarchy masquerades as community good. Further development: This is where the supplementary bridges are most useful. Common good survives in plural society only as a rights-bounded, contestable and revisable standard. Conclusion: Yes, but only if common good is defined against state good, majority good and utilitarian expendability, and is disciplined by equal citizenship, dissent, review and constitutional morality.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Common-good, Core and Once), converts that evidence into analysis of common-good reasoning be defended in a plural society without sacrificing minority rights, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Yes, but only if common good is defined against state good, majority good and utilitarian expendability, and is disciplined by equal citizenship, dissent, review and constitutional morality. At 213 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Marxian, Gandhian and Aristotelian approaches to the common good. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of marxian, Gandhian and Aristotelian approaches to the common good in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Aristotle, Marx and Gandhi, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: All three reject narrow private self-interest, yet Aristotle locates common good in right constitutional order, Marx in overcoming class domination, and Gandhi in moral self-restraint and sarvodaya;.

Model answer (249 words):

Introduction: Aristotle, Marx and Gandhi all reject the idea that politics is merely the registration of private appetite, yet they reach the common good through very different routes. Aristotle is constitutional and teleological, Marx structural and conflictual, Gandhi moral and civilisational. Core analysis: For Aristotle, the right constitution serves the good life of the whole community; the political order is judged by whether it advances the advantage of the whole rather than one class. Marx begins elsewhere. In a class-divided society, he denies that a genuine common good is available at all, because antagonistic ownership structures organise power and interest. Common good becomes fully meaningful only in communist association after class domination is overcome. Gandhi again shifts the ground. He seeks common good through trusteeship, bread labour, non-possession, non-violence and sarvodaya, so that moral self-restraint replaces both capitalist greed and violent levelling. On property and conflict, then, Aristotle seeks right ordering, Marx seeks abolition of class antagonism, and Gandhi seeks ethical transformation. Further development: Aquinas and Hegel should appear only as bounded comparative bridges, not as direct Gauba Ch.21 evidence. Aquinas extends the flourishing genealogy; Hegel shows freedom mediated through ethical institutions. A high-quality comparison preserves these distinct problem-settings instead of turning all three into vague theories of welfare. Conclusion: All three reject narrow private self-interest, yet Aristotle locates common good in right constitutional order, Marx in overcoming class domination, and Gandhi in moral self-restraint and sarvodaya; no serious comparison should flatten these distinct routes into one doctrine.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Aristotle, Marx and Gandhi), converts that evidence into analysis of marxian, Gandhian and Aristotelian approaches to the common good, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: All three reject narrow private self-interest, yet Aristotle locates common good in right constitutional order, Marx in overcoming class domination, and Gandhi in moral self-restraint and sarvodaya;. At 249 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
